Partner portal: one pager

Nov 5, 2026 · @Man Yong Toh

A partner portal replaces partner mail with structured answers, so the back office stops chasing and the brain stops guessing. The portal for local agents is now built and tested in the sandbox; the API route for western partners waits until their systems are known.

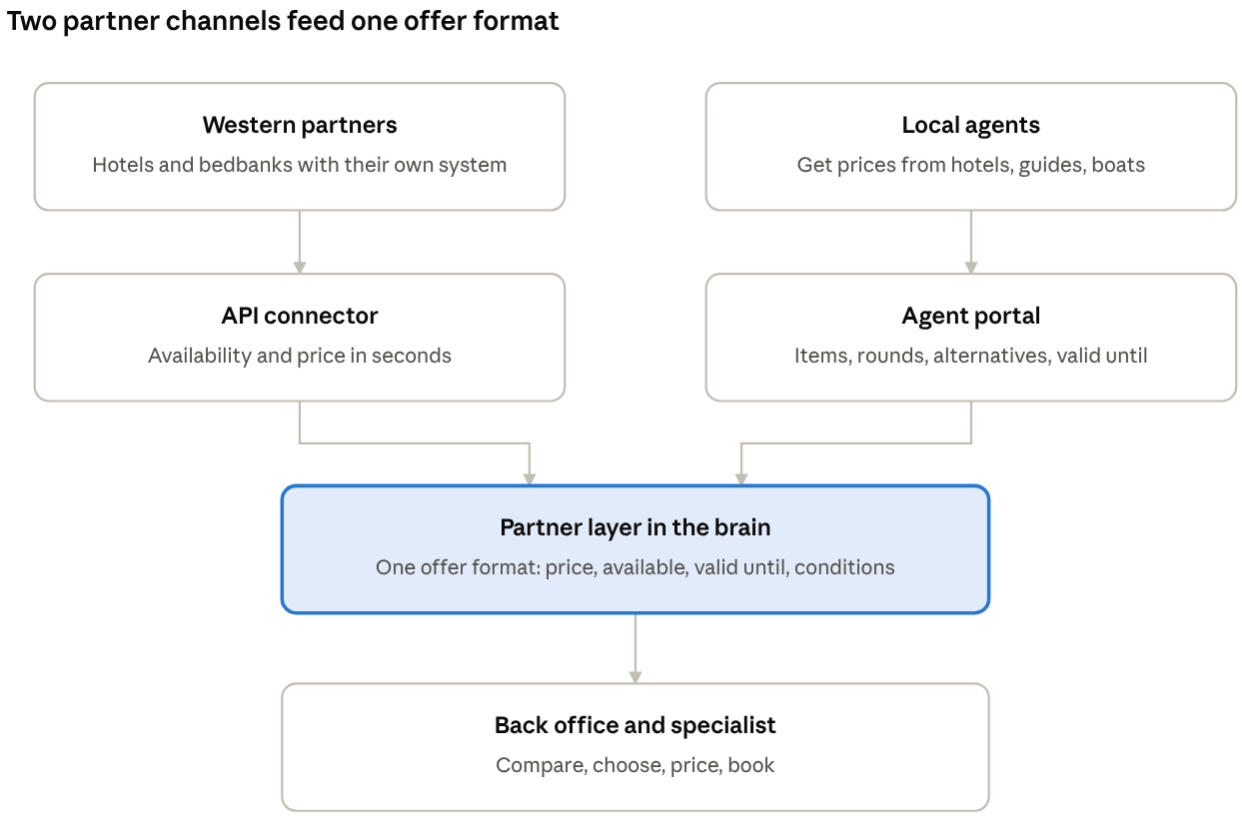
Why

Partner mail is the slowest and most fragile step between a family's wish and a proposal. Testing the sandbox on realistic partner mail showed what goes wrong when answers arrive as free text:

- Replies without a booking number, or from an address the system does not know, have to be matched by hand.
- Vague answers ("we will come back to you") look like a yes; a price like "EUR 1.240" is easily misread.
- Partners are chased by hand, often after they already answered.
- Every request takes several rounds of mail, and nobody sees which item is still open.

Two channels, one offer format

Western partners usually have a system of their own, so the brain asks it directly and gets availability and price in seconds. Local agents in Asia and Africa first ask hotels, guides and boat owners themselves, so they get a portal built for that back-and-forth. Both end in the same offer format, so the board, the comparison, the invoice check and the booking check work the same whatever the source.



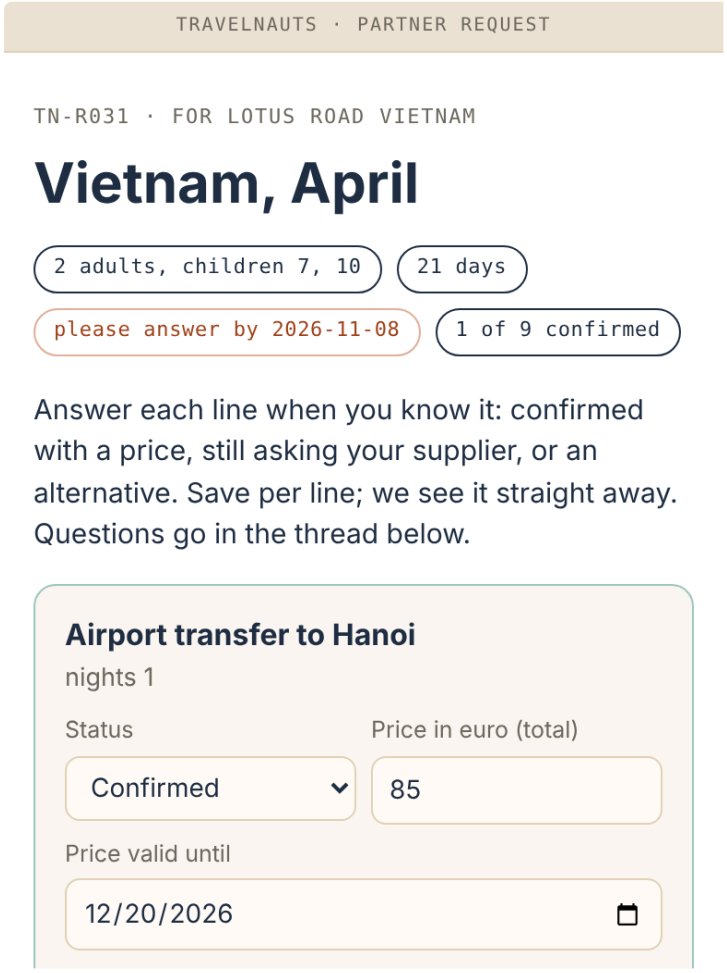
partner channels · API for western partners, portal for local agents

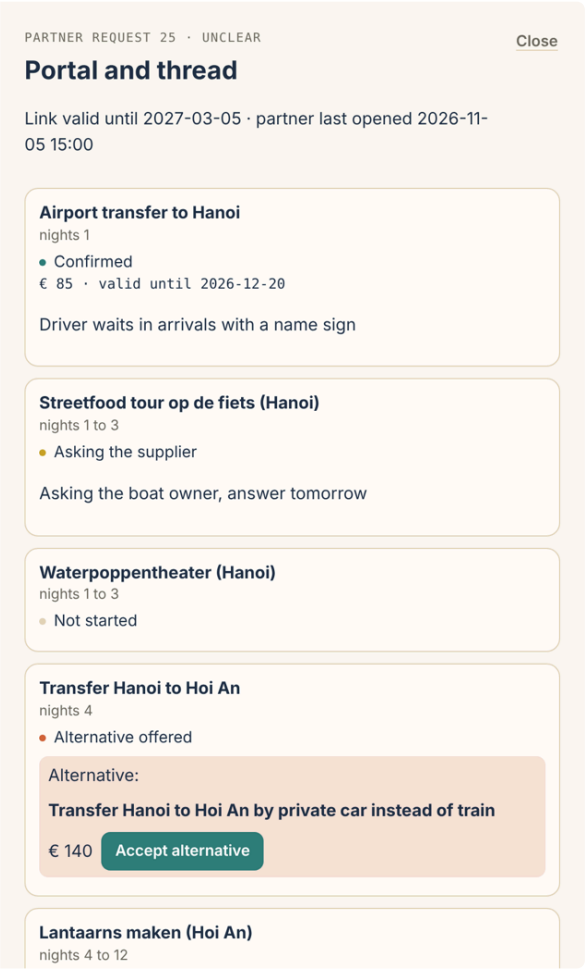
The agent portal

A request reaches the local agent as a list of items to price, each with its own status and conversation, instead of one long mail.

Feature	What it does (as built)
Lines, not one answer	Every transfer, excursion or room is its own line with a status: not started, asking the supplier, confirmed with a price, alternative offered, not available. The agent confirms what is ready and comes back for the rest.
Alternatives in a fixed format	"Train sold out: private car instead, € 140" arrives as an alternative with a price. The back office or the specialist accepts it in one click; the line turns confirmed and the partner sees "please book it".
A thread per line	Each line has its own short thread, numbered by round, plus one for the whole request. Nothing gets lost in a mail chain.

Feature	What it does (as built)
Valid until	Every confirmed price can carry an end date. The offer takes the earliest one; once it passes, the offer no longer counts as confirmed for the proposal.
Deadlines, no needless reminders	The agent sees the answer-by date. While they are working in the portal no reminder mail goes out; reply times feed the partner scores.
Documents	Agents can upload a PDF offer (PDF only, up to 5 MB); it is kept with the request. Mail keeps working as a fallback.
Privacy	The agent sees "2 adults, children 7 and 10", the route and dates, never names or contact details. Their text is checked for hidden instructions and always shown as plain text.
Access	A link per request, no account, works on a phone. Valid until departure or 120 days; a new link stops the old one. A WhatsApp notice is a natural extra.





What it gives Travelnauts

- **Less back office work:** no matching, chasing or retyping of partner answers; people handle only the exceptions.
- **Faster proposals:** specialists see per item what is confirmed, instead of waiting for one complete mail.
- **Fewer errors:** prices, dates and availability arrive as fields, not text to interpret.
- **Partners measured:** reply time, reply rate and price validity per partner, so the best partners get the work.
- **A base for later steps:** the same offer format feeds the family-facing proposal page and app in phase 2.

Questions and next steps

- [ ] Which western partners and systems does Travelnauts work with (bedbanks, hotel chains with their own API)?
- [ ] How many local agents are there, and how do they communicate today (mail, WhatsApp, phone)?
- [ ] May agents see a family's details before booking, or only the party and ages?
- [ ] Pick two or three willing local agents for a first trial.

Built and tested in the sandbox on 5 November 2026: phone and computer, script-safe partner text, no family data shown. A two-page guide for local agents is ready to send with the first link. Western connectors follow once the systems are known.